NCE Printable Flashcards

168 cut-and-fold cards for key terms, theorists, and statistics

Free Reader Bonus #4 for NCE Exam Prep 2026–2027

Keystone Test Prep Team

NCE Printable Flashcards

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How to Use Your Flashcards

Flashcards work because they force retrieval: you have to pull the answer out of memory before you see it. That effort is what makes learning stick. These cards cover the key terms, theorists, and statistics concepts that appear again and again on the NCE.

1. **Print single-sided** on regular or card-stock paper.
2. **Cut along the dashed lines** around each card.
3. **Fold along the dotted center line** so the shaded side (the prompt) is on the front and the answer is on the back. A dab of glue keeps each card closed.
4. **Sort as you study.** Keep three piles: "Know it," "Almost," and "Not yet." Review "Not yet" every day, "Almost" every few days, and "Know it" once a week.
5. **Say it before you flip.** Answer out loud or in writing before checking. A vague "I sort of know this" counts as "Not yet."

Deck 1: Key Terms (59 Cards)

Abandonment	Ending counseling inappropriately, without notice, referral, or attention to client needs.
Abstinence violation effect	Guilt and all-or-nothing thinking after a lapse that can lead to full relapse.
Accommodation (Piaget)	Changing existing mental structures to fit new information.
Aftercare plan	Services and supports arranged to follow discharge from a level of care.
Assent	Agreement to services by a person who cannot give legal consent, such as a minor.
Assimilation (Piaget)	Fitting new information into existing mental structures.

Bracketing	Setting aside one's own assumptions to understand another person's experience.
Broaching	A counselor's intentional invitation to discuss cultural factors relevant to the client or relationship.
Burnout	Exhaustion, cynicism, and reduced efficacy from chronic workplace stress.
Business associate agreement (BAA)	A HIPAA contract requiring vendors that handle PHI to protect it.
Case conceptualization	An organized explanation of a client's difficulties that guides treatment.
Collateral information	Information about a client from sources other than the client.

Compassion fatigue	Exhaustion from caring for suffering people, often combining burnout and secondary traumatic stress.
Confidentiality	The counselor's ethical and legal duty to protect client information.
Congruence	Genuineness; consistency between the counselor's inner experience and outward expression.
Consultation	A voluntary, nonhierarchical relationship focused on a specific professional issue.
Contraindication	A reason not to use a particular intervention with a particular client.
Countertransference	A counselor's emotional reactions to a client rooted in the counselor's own history.

CPT code	A code describing a health care service for billing.
Cultural concept of distress	A culturally specific way of experiencing, expressing, or explaining distress.
Differentiation of self	Bowen's term for remaining connected to family while maintaining one's own thoughts and feelings.
Discharge plan	A document describing the end of an episode of care, progress, needs, and next steps.
Duty to protect	A legal obligation in some states to take reasonable steps to protect identifiable people from a client's serious threats.
Empathy	Understanding a client's inner world as if it were one's own and communicating that understanding.

Evidence-based practice	Integrating research, clinical expertise, and client characteristics and preferences.
Externalizing	A narrative technique that separates the person from the problem.
Fact witness	A witness who testifies about direct observations.
Formative evaluation	Evaluation during a program or process to improve it.
Genogram	A multigenerational family diagram.
Informed consent	The process of giving clients the information needed to make free decisions about services.

Lapse	A single slip back into an old behavior.
Lethal means counseling	Working with clients to reduce access to highly lethal methods during periods of risk.
Level of care	The intensity and setting of services, from prevention to inpatient care.
Linking	A group skill that connects members' experiences.
Medical necessity	The standard insurers use to determine whether services are needed to treat a condition.
Mental status examination	A structured description of current mental functioning.

Minimum necessary	Sharing only the information needed for a specific purpose.
Parallel process	Dynamics from counseling appearing in supervision, or the reverse.
Privileged communication	Legal protection of client communications from disclosure in court; belongs to the client.
Professional will	A document naming a colleague to manage clients and records if a counselor dies or is incapacitated.
Psychotherapy notes	Under HIPAA, separately kept notes analyzing session content, with extra protection.
Relapse	A return to a previous pattern of behavior.

Reliability	Consistency of measurement.
Rupture	A strain or breakdown in the therapeutic alliance.
Safety plan	A written, collaborative plan a client can use during a suicidal crisis.
Secondary traumatic stress	Trauma-like symptoms from exposure to others' trauma.
SMART goal	A goal that is specific, measurable, attainable, realistic, and timely.
Standard error of measurement	An estimate of the spread of observed scores around a true score.

Subpoena	A legal document requiring testimony or documents; not the same as a court order.
Summative evaluation	Evaluation at the end of a program to judge its overall effectiveness.
Supervision	An evaluative, hierarchical, ongoing relationship that protects clients and develops counselors.
Transference	A client's redirection of feelings from past relationships onto the counselor.
Triangulation	Pulling a third person into a two-person conflict.
Unconditional positive regard	Accepting and valuing a client without judgment.

Universality	The group factor of realizing others share similar struggles.
Validity	The degree to which evidence supports score interpretations for an intended purpose.
Vicarious trauma	Lasting changes in a counselor's beliefs and worldview from empathic engagement with trauma.
Warm handoff	A referral in which the counselor directly connects the client with the new provider.
Wraparound	A team-based, family-driven planning process for people with complex needs across systems.

Deck 2: Theorists and Theories (54 Cards)

Sigmund Freud	**Psychoanalysis.** Id, ego, superego; unconscious; psychosexual stages; defense mechanisms. *Key techniques or terms:* Free association, dream analysis, interpretation, transference.
Carl Jung	**Analytical psychology.** Collective unconscious, archetypes, persona, shadow, individuation. *Key techniques or terms:* Dream work, exploration of archetypes.
Alfred Adler	**Individual psychology.** Social interest, inferiority, lifestyle, birth order, private logic. *Key techniques or terms:* Early recollections, encouragement, acting as if, spitting in the soup.
Carl Rogers	**Person-centered.** Actualizing tendency, conditions of worth, incongruence. *Key techniques or terms:* Empathy, unconditional positive regard, congruence.
Viktor Frankl	**Logotherapy (existential).** Will to meaning, meaning in suffering. *Key techniques or terms:* Paradoxical intention, dereflection.
Rollo May, Irvin Yalom	**Existential therapy.** Death, freedom, isolation, meaninglessness. *Key techniques or terms:* Exploring responsibility and meaning.

Fritz and Laura Perls	**Gestalt therapy.** Here and now, awareness, unfinished business, contact boundaries. *Key techniques or terms:* Empty chair, two-chair, exaggeration.
Ivan Pavlov, John B. Watson	**Classical conditioning.** Learned associations between stimuli. *Key techniques or terms:* Conditioning, extinction.
B. F. Skinner	**Operant conditioning.** Reinforcement, punishment, schedules. *Key techniques or terms:* Token economies, shaping.
Joseph Wolpe	**Behavior therapy.** Reciprocal inhibition. *Key techniques or terms:* Systematic desensitization.
Albert Bandura	**Social learning (social cognitive) theory.** Modeling, self-efficacy, reciprocal determinism. *Key techniques or terms:* Modeling, behavioral rehearsal.
Albert Ellis	**Rational emotive behavior therapy.** ABC model, irrational beliefs, "musts," unconditional self-acceptance. *Key techniques or terms:* Disputing (ABCDE).

Aaron Beck	**Cognitive therapy / CBT.** Automatic thoughts, schemas, cognitive triad, distortions. *Key techniques or terms:* Socratic questioning, thought records, behavioral experiments.
Donald Meichenbaum	**Cognitive behavior modification.** Self-talk. *Key techniques or terms:* Stress inoculation, self-instructional training.
William Glasser, Robert Wubbolding	**Reality therapy / choice theory.** Five basic needs, quality world, responsibility. *Key techniques or terms:* WDEP, planning.
Steve de Shazer, Insoo Kim Berg	**Solution-focused brief therapy.** Exceptions, client strengths, small changes. *Key techniques or terms:* Miracle, exception, scaling, coping questions.
Michael White, David Epston	**Narrative therapy.** Problem-saturated stories, re-authoring. *Key techniques or terms:* Externalizing, unique outcomes.
William Miller, Stephen Rollnick	**Motivational interviewing.** Ambivalence, change talk, spirit of MI. *Key techniques or terms:* OARS, rolling with discord, decisional balance.

Marsha Linehan	**Dialectical behavior therapy.** Acceptance and change; biosocial theory. *Key techniques or terms:* Mindfulness, distress tolerance, emotion regulation, interpersonal effectiveness.
Steven Hayes	**Acceptance and commitment therapy.** Psychological flexibility. *Key techniques or terms:* Defusion, acceptance, values, committed action.
Segal, Williams, Teasdale	**Mindfulness-based cognitive therapy.** Relapse prevention for recurrent depression. *Key techniques or terms:* Mindfulness practices with cognitive principles.
Cohen, Mannarino, Deblinger	**Trauma-focused CBT.** Child trauma with caregiver involvement. *Key techniques or terms:* PRACTICE components.
Patricia Resick	**Cognitive processing therapy.** Stuck points about trauma. *Key techniques or terms:* Challenging beliefs; trauma themes.
Edna Foa	**Prolonged exposure.** Emotional processing of trauma. *Key techniques or terms:* Imaginal and in vivo exposure.

Francine Shapiro	**EMDR.** Adaptive information processing. *Key techniques or terms:* Bilateral stimulation, eight phases.
Richard Schwartz	**Internal family systems.** Self and parts (managers, firefighters, exiles). *Key techniques or terms:* Parts work.
Murray Bowen	**Family systems (multigenerational).** Differentiation, triangles, emotional cutoff, multigenerational transmission. *Key techniques or terms:* Genogram, detriangling.
Salvador Minuchin	**Structural family therapy.** Subsystems, boundaries, hierarchy. *Key techniques or terms:* Joining, enactments, restructuring.
Jay Haley, Cloé Madanes	**Strategic family therapy.** Power, hierarchy, attempted solutions. *Key techniques or terms:* Directives, paradox, ordeals.
Virginia Satir	**Experiential / human validation.** Self-esteem, communication stances. *Key techniques or terms:* Family sculpting.

Carl Whitaker	**Symbolic-experiential therapy.** Spontaneity, growth. *Key techniques or terms:* Use of self, absurdity.
Sue Johnson	**Emotionally focused therapy.** Attachment, negative interaction cycles. *Key techniques or terms:* Accessing and reshaping emotions.
John and Julie Gottman	**Gottman method.** Four Horsemen, Sound Relationship House. *Key techniques or terms:* Gentle start-up, repair attempts.
Irvin Yalom	**Group psychotherapy.** Therapeutic factors. *Key techniques or terms:* Here-and-now process.
Bruce Tuckman	**Group development.** Forming, storming, norming, performing, adjourning. *Key techniques or terms:* Stage-matched leadership.
Frank Parsons	**Trait-and-factor career theory.** Self-knowledge, knowledge of work, true reasoning. *Key techniques or terms:* Matching.

John Holland	**Vocational personalities.** RIASEC, congruence, consistency, differentiation, identity. *Key techniques or terms:* Self-Directed Search.
Donald Super	**Life-span, life-space.** Self-concept, life stages, life-career rainbow. *Key techniques or terms:* Career maturity and adaptability.
John Krumboltz	**Social learning theory of career decision making.** Genetic endowment, environment, learning experiences, task approach skills. *Key techniques or terms:* Planned happenstance.
Linda Gottfredson	**Circumscription and compromise.** Narrowing by sex type and prestige. *Key techniques or terms:* Exploring eliminated options.
Lent, Brown, Hackett	**Social cognitive career theory.** Self-efficacy, outcome expectations, goals. *Key techniques or terms:* Addressing barriers and supports.
Mark Savickas	**Career construction.** Life themes, career adaptability. *Key techniques or terms:* Career story interview.

Erik Erikson	**Psychosocial development.** Eight stages and crises. *Key techniques or terms:* Stage-based understanding.
Jean Piaget	**Cognitive development.** Schemas, assimilation, accommodation; four stages. *Key techniques or terms:* Developmentally matched interventions.
Lawrence Kohlberg	**Moral development.** Preconventional, conventional, postconventional. *Key techniques or terms:* Moral dilemmas.
Carol Gilligan	**Ethic of care.** Care-based moral reasoning. *Key techniques or terms:* Relational focus.
John Bowlby, Mary Ainsworth	**Attachment theory.** Secure base; secure, avoidant, resistant, disorganized. *Key techniques or terms:* Strange Situation.
Urie Bronfenbrenner	**Ecological systems.** Micro, meso, exo, macro, chrono systems. *Key techniques or terms:* Contextual assessment.

Prochaska, DiClemente	**Transtheoretical model.** Stages of change. *Key techniques or terms:* Stage-matched interventions.
Marlatt, Gordon	**Relapse prevention.** High-risk situations, abstinence violation effect. *Key techniques or terms:* Coping plans.
Kübler-Ross; Worden; Stroebe and Schut	**Grief models.** Stages (not linear); tasks of mourning; dual process. *Key techniques or terms:* Grief counseling.
Gerald Caplan	**Mental health consultation.** Client- and consultee-centered, case and administrative. *Key techniques or terms:* Consultation types.
Janine Bernard	**Discrimination model of supervision.** Teacher, counselor, consultant roles. *Key techniques or terms:* Intervention, conceptualization, personalization.
Stoltenberg and colleagues	**Integrated Developmental Model.** Levels 1–3 of supervisee growth. *Key techniques or terms:* Developmentally matched supervision.

Deck 3: Statistics and Assessment (55 Cards)

Nominal scale	Categories with names only (diagnosis type)
Ordinal scale	Ranked order without equal spacing (class rank)
Interval scale	Equal spacing, no true zero (Fahrenheit)
Ratio scale	Equal spacing with a true zero (number of sessions)
Mean	Average; pulled toward extreme scores
Median	Middle score

Mode	Most frequent score
Positive skew	Tail to the right; mean > median > mode; hard test
Negative skew	Tail to the left; mean < median < mode; easy test
Range	Highest minus lowest score
Variance	Average squared distance from the mean
Standard deviation	Typical distance from the mean

Normal curve	About 68% within ±1 SD, 95% within ±2 SD, 99.7% within ±3 SD
Percentile rank	Percent of norm group scoring at or below a score; not percent correct
z-score	Mean 0, SD 1
T-score	Mean 50, SD 10
Deviation IQ	Mean 100, SD 15
Stanine	Nine bands; mean 5, SD about 2

Correlation (r)	Strength and direction of a relationship, −1 to +1; not causation
Coefficient of determination	r squared; shared variance
Reliability	Consistency of scores
Test-retest reliability	Stability over time
Alternate forms reliability	Equivalence of two versions
Split-half reliability	Agreement of two halves; Spearman-Brown correction

Internal consistency	Items measure the same thing; Cronbach's alpha, KR-20
Inter-rater reliability	Agreement between scorers; Cohen's kappa
Standard error of measurement	Expected spread of observed scores around the true score; ±1 SEM ≈ 68%, ±2 SEM ≈ 95%
Validity	Accuracy of score interpretations for a purpose
Content validity	Items cover the content domain
Concurrent validity	Relates to a criterion measured now

Predictive validity	Predicts a future criterion
Construct validity	Measures the theoretical trait; includes convergent and discriminant evidence
Face validity	Looks like it measures the trait; not true validity
Sensitivity	Correctly identifies people who have the condition
Specificity	Correctly rules out people who do not have the condition
Norm-referenced	Compared with a norm group

Criterion-referenced	Compared with a fixed standard
Ipsative	Compared with the person's own other scores
Speed vs. power test	Many easy items under time pressure vs. harder items with ample time
Independent variable	What the researcher manipulates or groups by
Dependent variable	The outcome measured
Internal validity	Confidence that the intervention caused the change

External validity	Generalizability of results
Type I error	False positive; rejecting a true null hypothesis
Type II error	False negative; missing a real effect
Alpha level	Probability of Type I error, often 0.05
Power	Probability of detecting a real effect; increases with sample size
Effect size	Size of an effect; Cohen's d ≈ 0.2 small, 0.5 medium, 0.8 large

t-test	Compares two means
ANOVA	Compares three or more means
Chi-square	Compares frequencies in categories
Regression	Predicts an outcome from predictors
Formative evaluation	Feedback during a program to improve it
Summative evaluation	Judgment of overall effectiveness at the end

Needs assessment	Identifies gaps before designing a program

One Small Request

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